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|--------------------|--------------|----------------|--------------|
| 2. A. discovered | B. learned | C. realized | D. wondered |
| 3. A. Finally | B. Suddenly | C. Immediately | D. Instead |
| 4. A. bought | B. saved | C. made | D. collected |
| 5. A. necessary | B. difficult | C. welcome | D. possible |
| 6. A. morning | B. noon | C. night | D. afternoon |
| 7. A. carefully | B. strictly | C. nervously | D. proudly |
| 8. A. pleased | B. satisfied | C. moved | D. puzzled |
| 9. A. disappointed | B. sorry | C. afraid | D. surprised |
| 10. A. deal | B. present | C. dream | D. decision |
| 11. A. bravery | B. honesty | C. suggestion | D. service |
| 12. A. curious | B. great | C. small | D. boring |
| 13. A. shared | B. created | C. believed | D. heard |
| 14. A. invite | B. remind | C. warn | D. require |
| 15. A. force | B. persuade | C. inspire | D. train |

Part II (30 Marks)

In this section, all your answers should be written on the answer sheet. Choose the best answer from all the options as the final answer.

Text 1

The traditional Chinese lunar calendar divides the year into 24 solar terms, which reflect the Chinese people's understanding of time. Here several special solar terms are listed.

Rain Water

Rain Water signals the increase in rainfall and rise in temperature. With its arrival, the river water defreezes, wild geese move from south to north, and trees and grass turn green again. Extra care is needed to cope with a returning cold spell in this period. The wet and damp weather during Rain Water period is considered harmful for people's spleen and stomach according to Chinese medical practice. Therefore, a bowl of nutritious porridge is the best choice to nourish the body.

Awakening of Insects

As the third solar term in the lunar year, its name implies that animals sleeping in winter are awakened by spring thunder and that the earth begins to come back to life. It is the key time for

spring agricultural activities. Modern meteorological science shows that around this period, the earth becomes wet, the hot humid air from the north is strong and creates frequent winds. For this reason, thunder often occurs.

Spring Equinox

Spring Equinox signals the equal length of the day and night time. On the day of the Spring Equinox, the sun is directly above the equator. After the equinox, the sun moves northwards, resulting in gradually longer day time in the Northern Hemisphere. Standing an egg upright is a popular game during this period. It is believed that if someone can make the egg stand, he will have good luck in the future.

Grain Rain

Grain Rain originates from the old saying, "Rain brings up the growth of hundreds of grains", which shows that this period of rainfall is extremely important for the growth of crops and people are busy working on the land. Grain Rain falls between the end of spring and the beginning of summer, with infrequent cold air moving to the south and lingering cold air in the north. With dry soil, an unsteady atmosphere and heavy winds and sandstorms become more frequent.

1. What can we know about Rain Water?
 - A. River water starts to freeze.
 - B. Taking off the thick coats is advisable.
 - C. Lively spring-like scenery can be seen.
 - D. It falls between the end of spring and the start of summer.
2. What do Awakening of Insects and Grain Rain have in common?
 - A. Farming season.
 - B. Animal activities.
 - C. Air temperature.
 - D. Frequent thundering.
3. In which solar term would people most probably put on masks?
 - A. Rain Water.
 - B. Grain Rain.
 - C. Spring Equinox.
 - D. Awakening of Insects.

Text 2

My philosophy professor was a typical eccentric philosopher, whose behavior was somewhat strange. His disheveled appearance was highlighted by a well-worn tweed sport coat and poor-fitting thick glasses, which often rested on the tip of his nose. Every now and then, as most

philosophy professors do, he would go off on one of those existential “what’s the meaning of life” discussions. Many of those discussions went nowhere, but there were a few that really hit home. This was one of them:

“Respond to the following questions by a show of hands, ” my professor instructed.

“How many of you can tell me something about your parents?” Everyone’s hand went up.

“How many of you can tell me something about your grandparents?” About three-fourths of the class raised their hands.

“How many of you can tell me something about your great-grandparents?” Two out of sixty students raised their hands.

“Look around the room, ” he said. “In just two short generations hardly any of us even know who our own great-grandparents were. Oh sure, maybe we have an old photograph tucked away in a musty cigar box or know the classic family story about how one of them walked five miles to school barefoot. But how many of us really know who they were, what they thought, what they were proud of, what they were afraid of, or what they dreamed about? Think about that. Within three generations our ancestors are all but forgotten. Will this happen to you?”

“Here’s a better question. Look ahead three generations. You are long gone. Instead of you sitting in this room, now it’s your great-grandchildren. What will they have to say about you? Will they know about you? Or will you be forgotten, too?”

“Is your life going to be a warning or an example? What legacy will you leave? The choice is yours. Class dismissed.”

Nobody rose from their seats for a good five minutes.

4. Which of the following can best describe the professor?

- A. Untidy but considerate.
- B. Odd but thoughtful.
- C. Fashionable and helpful.
- D. Neat and responsible.

5. Why does the professor mention “photograph” and “family story” in Paragraph 6?

- A. To share his own interesting stories.
- B. To suggest new ways to know the ancestors.
- C. To prove they are good ways to know the ancestors.

D. To show people's understanding of the ancestors are shallow.

6. What can we know about this philosophy class?

A. It aroused our thinking about life.

B. It went nowhere like the previous ones.

C. The professor was unsatisfied with our answers.

D. The professor offered us his answers to the questions.

7. What is the best title of the passage?

A. Our philosophy professor.

B. A lesson about legacy.

C. Our memorable ancestors.

D. A gap among three generations.

Text 3

Sitting back in my seat, I can't quite believe that I'm about to travel along the railway that many foreign experts claimed was "impossible". The train has been racing along steadily since it left Xining. All this time, the song "Sky Railway" has been playing inside my head. The words "railways like massive dragons are winding among the mountains" seem particularly vivid as I travel across the "roof of the world".

I was one of the people who came from all parts of China to work on this railway. Taking years to complete, the Qinghai-Tibet Railway is a record of all of our efforts to overcome the most difficult engineering challenges. How to protect the delicate ecosystem was among the top concerns.

The first landmark to catch my eye is the splendid Qingshuihe Bridge, the world's longest bridge built over permafrost. Look! A group of Tibetan antelopes is moving under the bridge, with some stopping to eat grass at their leisure. Thirty-three passages have been built under the railway to allow the animals to move safely and freely in their natural habitat. Wild animals such as these Tibetan antelopes have now been using these passages for years. They seem totally unaware that we are speeding past at over 100 kilometers an hour.

To prevent damage to wetlands and grasslands, 675 bridges with a total length of about 160 kilometers were built between Golmud and Lhasa. We even moved 140,000 square meters of wetland to a new area in order to protect its distinct ecosystem.

The journey has been flying by, and before I know it, we have reached Tanggula Station. Located at over 5,000 meters above sea level, this is the highest railway station in the world. In locations such as this, the thin air, changeable weather and high levels of UV radiation presented perhaps the greatest challenge for railway workers. To make sure we stayed healthy, several oxygen-making stations were constructed. We were also able to enjoy regular breaks in lower areas.

As we pass Cuona Lake, I feel a sense of pride and achievement. Using thousands and thousands of sandbags, we built a twenty-kilometer wall along the lake to protect it from construction waste. Cuona Lake is so close to the railway that I want to reach out and touch its pale blue mirror-like surface. Water birds playing in the lake, and cattle and sheep wandering the grasslands bring the scenery to life.

The Qinghai-Tibet Plateau has been attracting people's admiration for centuries. Now, thanks to our efforts, passengers from all over the country have been enjoying these magical landscapes. I am proud that we built our "impossible" railway, and did so with the care that the environment deserves. It truly is an extraordinary "Sky Railway".

8. Which of the following is TRUE according to the first two paragraphs?

- A. The song "Sky Railway" was played as background music in the train.
- B. Ways of protecting the delicate ecosystem were taken into consideration.
- C. Foreign experts were frightened to see dragons among the mountains.
- D. The author kept the record of solving the toughest engineering problem.

9. Which can best replace the underlined part in Paragraph 3?

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| A. without interruption | B. for entertainment |
| C. in their free time | D. without hurrying |

10. Why was a 20-km wall built according to Paragraph 6?

- A. Because it separated the habitats of birds and cattle.
- B. Because it transformed construction waste into sand.
- C. Because it kept Cuona lake from being polluted.
- D. Because it connected Cuona lake and the railway.

11. What is the author proud of at the end of the passage?

- A. Their efforts to build the railway and protect the ecosystem.

- B. That he has made the railway extraordinary for tourists.
 - C. Passengers' admiration for the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau.
 - D. The splendid landscapes along the Sky Railway.
12. What is the author's purpose in writing the passage?
- A. To prove that humans can conquer nature.
 - B. To advertise the travel route along the Qinghai-Tibet Railway.
 - C. To praise the workers' efforts in building the Qinghai-Tibet Railway.
 - D. To highlight the amount of work required to build the Qinghai-Tibet Railway.

Text 4

Learning how to dance, play a musical instrument, or create a comic strip isn't just fun. According to the National Endowment for the Arts, kids who study art are four times more likely to be recognized for academic achievement. Why? Research shows that arts education can strengthen critical thinking, memory, and even math skills. Access to music, dance, and arts programs is especially important for children in low-income communities.

With fund shortages a concern, organizations around the country help schools introduce students to the arts. In my area, the Milwaukee Symphony Orchestra's Arts in Community Education (ACE) program adds arts education in local public and private schools. Started in 1990, the program includes school visits from musicians and actors and field trips to art museums and theaters.

To learn more about ACE, I spoke with Rebecca Whitney, who is the program's director of education. She explained that ACE was designed to deepen students' understanding of the world through music, dance, and even drama.

Expanding horizons and providing access to everyone are the most important. "The important value of arts education is to teach and inspire creativity, cooperation, community, and connections," Whitney said. "Most schools pay only \$17 per student for all of the programming."

Since it was set up, ACE has inspired tens of thousands of young people, including me. I was a member of the ACE program in elementary school. I remember taking a trip to the Milwaukee Symphony Orchestra, which fuels my love for the performing arts. I now play the violin for a local symphony orchestra. My friend, Isabella Krynicka, is also a member of the orchestra and ACE. "It was so inspirational to watch professional musicians perform," she recalled.

Now that pandemic restrictions are easing, ACE will continue its in-person programs at schools. "The most rewarding part of working with ACE," Whitney said, "is seeing the excitement and wonder students and teachers have."

13. What's the aim of ACE?

- A. To improve students' academic achievements.
- B. To help kids understand the world better through arts.
- C. To raise funds for children in low-income communities.
- D. To choose talented children for the Milwaukee Symphony Orchestra.

14. How did Isabella Krynicka feel after watching professional musicians perform?

- A. Discouraged.
- B. Unexpected.
- C. Pleased.
- D. Encouraged.

15. What is the passage mainly about?

- A. An important program.
- B. The importance of education.
- C. The introduction of an organization.
- D. The significance of arts education.

Part III (10 Marks)

Complete the passage in the appropriate form of words. Read the passage below and fill in the blanks with an appropriate word or the correct form of the word in brackets.

A. hairdressing B. hairstyle C. smooth D. soap E. concerned F. products G. fashionable H. thinking I. shampoo J. conditioner K. brushes
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In the 1970s, most Chinese people used to wash their hair with ____ 1 _____. It was not until the early 1980s that ____ 2 _____ became popular in China. But ever since then, things have developed at great speed. A wide variety of ____ 3 _____ related to hair have made their way into every single family, such as shampoo, conditioner, hair cream, hair oil, brilliant hair decorations, hair ____ 4 _____, hair driers and so on. Cleanliness is not the final purpose. People become more ____ 5 _____ with the quality of the hair. They lay more stresses on how to make their hair ____ 6 _____, shiny and healthy. In order to make their hair and themselves look the best, many

people buy hair products in high quality and choose the right shampoo and _____ 7 _____ suitable for their own hair. More and more people pay regular visits to full-service salons to nurse their hair.

Apart from pursuing the best quality of the hair, people also pay more attention to _____ 8 _____ fashion. As we know, the fashions in clothes are constantly changing, and so are hairdressing fashions. In the 1980s, most women had their hair permed ; in the 1990s _____ 9 _____ ladies poured into the hairdressing salons to have the hair colored. But nowadays, shiny black is again the most attractive color of hair for the easterners, and fashion followers would like to spend a lot to make their hair extremely straight.

Some sensible people prefer to choose the _____ 10 _____ fit for the shapes of their faces, their jobs or even for their personalities rather than blindly copy that of the other people.

Part IV (30 Marks)

If you are Alex, your friend Lily wrote you an email saying that she had trouble with her good friend Lucy because Lucy lost her favorite book. She doesn't know what to do and wants to ask you for help. Now please reply an email to Lily and put forward suggestions to help her solve this problem.

Note: 1 The number of words is about 80.

2. Details can be added appropriately to make the text coherent.
